

Maintenance Change Control & Method of Procedure (MOP) Standard

Data Centre Portfolio · Data Centre · Singapore & Europe

Document ID	DC-07
Category	Operational Excellence
Classification	Operational
Date	2024-08
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1. Why this standard exists

A review of 48 incidents across the data-centre portfolio in 2022-2023 found that 40% were caused by human error during planned maintenance: operating the wrong breaker, skipping a step or making an untested change. Most happened during routine work that 'everyone knew how to do'.

2. Method of Procedure (MOP) requirements

- Every maintenance activity that can affect redundancy or customer load requires a written MOP.
- A MOP contains the scope, a risk assessment, step-by-step actions with verification points, expected system states, a rollback plan and a communications plan.
- MOPs are graded by risk; Level 3 (high-risk) MOPs require peer review and approval by the change advisory board.
- A pre-task briefing is held on site before work starts, walking the team through the MOP and the rollback steps.
- Two-person verification for all electrical switching: one person reads the step, the other performs it.

3. Customer communication

- Customers receive notice at least five business days before any work that reduces redundancy, with the start time, expected duration and the risk mitigation in place.
- Live status updates are sent at the start and end of work, and immediately if anything deviates from the plan.
- A post-work summary is shared for high-risk activities.

4. Results

KPI	2022-2023	2024-2025
Incidents caused by human error (per year)	9.6	3.8
Maintenance activities with a MOP	55%	100%
Customer complaints about maintenance	14	3

5. Lessons learned

- MOPs must be usable in the field: checklists, not essays.
- Rehearse complex or rare works on a mock-up or in a quiet period.
- Proactive communication builds trust. Customers tolerate planned work they are told about; surprises damage relationships far more than the work itself.